

A Fragment of the Root Tantra of the Vajra Kīla

Vajrakīlaya Mūlatantra Khaṇḍa · Toh 439 · Derge Kangyur

རྡོ་ཤུལ་པ་རྩལ་རྩལ་གྱི་རྩལ་བ།

The Fragment of the Root Tantra of the Vajra Kīla, known in Sanskrit as the Vajrakīlaya Mūlatantra Khaṇḍa and in Tibetan as Dorje Phurpa Tsawé Gyü Kyi Dumbu, is a tantric text belonging to the Vajrakīlaya cycle, one of the most important traditions of wrathful deity practice in Tibetan Buddhism. It concerns the fierce deity Vajrakumāra, the Vajra Youth, and presents teachings on the transformation of negative forces — particularly aversion — through the ritual and meditative power of the kīla, or ritual dagger, understood as an emanation of vajra wrath and compassion. The text weaves together verse, mantra, and doctrinal instruction, treating the kīla not as an instrument of mere destruction but as a means of liberating beings by transmuting the aggregates of existence into vajra. It is Toh 439 in the Kangyur, where it is classified among the tantric scriptures, and survives as a fragment, suggesting it represents a portion of a larger root tantra rather than a complete and self-contained work.

In the language of India: Vajrakīlaya Mūlatantra Khaṇḍa. In the language of Tibet: A Fragment of the Root Tantra of the Vajra Kīla.

Homage to the Blessed One, Vajrakumāra.

The vajra wrathful one severs aversion,
the great blue weapon blazing intensely.

A bindu arises in the middle of space,
arising as the gateway of the life-force,
and is to be meditated upon in the center of the heart.

The sacred commitment of liberation through compassion
is not mere killing and suppression:
the very essence of the vajra of the aggregates —
meditate on consciousness as vajra.

Oṃ vajrakīlikīlaya sarva-vighnaṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Dīptacakra hana hana hūṃ phaṭ.

May the vidyādhara of Vajrakumāra
accomplish the turning of saṃsāra into vajra.
May the deity of the Vajra Kīla, the vajra of saṃsāra,
be accomplished as the wrathful one of primordial wisdom.
The wisdom body of all buddhas,

arising from the very nature of vajra suchness,
the essential nature of the dharmadhātu —
through the unbearable blazing wrathful one,
may I be born as the treasure of the body.
Acting with skillful means for the benefit of sentient beings,
taming them with loving-kindness and compassion,
may the enlightened activity of the buddhas be perfected.
Grant here empowerment and blessing.

Oṃ vajrakrodha hūṃkara hūṃ. Garḍa garḍa hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajrakrodhī
dīpayati hūṃ. Oṃ vajrasūkaramukha hūṃ. Oṃ vajraiṣupamukhī hūṃ.

These are the Great Wrathful One Hūṃkāra; the vajra goddess Sounding One;
and the emanation goddesses, the minor consorts — the one with a pig's head
and the one with a brahman's head.

Oṃ vajrakrodha vijaya hūṃ. Hana hana hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajrakrodhī lāsyaki
hūṃ. Oṃ vajravyaḡhramukha hūṃ. Oṃ vajragṛdhramukhī hūṃ.

These are the Great Wrathful One Vijaya; the vajra goddess the Coquettish
One; and the emanation goddesses, the minor consorts — the one with a
tiger's head and the one with a vulture's head.

Oṃ vajrakrodha nīladaṇḍa hūṃ. Daha daha hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajrakrodhī tītāru
hūṃ. Oṃ vajracāmaramukha hūṃ. Oṃ vajratānamukhī hūṃ.

These are the Wrathful One Who Wields the Blue Staff; the goddess
Vajra-Clawed One; and the emanation goddesses, the minor consorts — the
one with a yak's head and the one with a crow's head.

Oṃ vajrakrodha yamāntaka hūṃ. Paca paca hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajrakrodhī
śmaśānapati hūṃ. Oṃ vajrahariṇamukha hūṃ. Oṃ vajroulūkamukhī hūṃ.

These are the Wrathful One Yamāntaka; the vajra goddess Mistress of the
Charnel Ground; and the emanation goddesses, the minor consorts — the one
with a deer's head and the one with an owl's head.

Oṃ vajrakrodha āryācala hūṃ. Bandha bandha hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajrakrodhī
Muhala hūṃ. Oṃ vajratyakimukha hūṃ. Oṃ vajrapretamukhī hūṃ.

These are the Wrathful One Immovable Protector (Acala); the vajra goddess
the Crushing One; and the emanation goddesses, the minor consorts — the
one with a leopard's head and the one with a hawk's head.

Oṃ vajrakrodha hayagrīva hūṃ. Hulu hulu hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajrakrodhī jayati hūṃ. Oṃ vajravaitālamukha hūṃ. Oṃ vajrapakṣitamukhī hūṃ.

These are the Wrathful One Hayagrīva; the vajra goddess the Fierce One; and the emanation goddesses, the minor consorts — the one with a cat's head and the one with a screech-owl's head.

Oṃ vajrakrodha aparājita hūṃ. Tiṣṭha tiṣṭha hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajrakrodhī savyati hūṃ. Oṃ vajraśṛṅgālamukha hūṃ. Oṃ vajrapañcaraṇamukhī hūṃ.

These are the Wrathful One Aparājita, the Unconquerable; the vajra goddess the Arrow-Proud One; and the emanation goddesses, the minor consorts — the one with a jackal's head and the one with a hawk's head.

Oṃ vajrakrodha amṛtakuṇḍali hūṃ. Chinda chinda hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajrakrodhī savyamiti hūṃ. Oṃ vajrasimhamukha hūṃ. Oṃ vajratitilamukhī hūṃ.

These are the Wrathful One Amṛtakuṇḍalin; the vajra goddess the Sound-Maker; and the emanation goddesses, the minor consorts — the one with a lion's head and the one with a phavāṅga's head.

Oṃ vajrakrodha trailokyavijaya hūṃ. Bindha bindha hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajrakrodhī mārāya hūṃ. Oṃ vajrarākṣasamukha hūṃ. Oṃ vajranakulamukhī hūṃ.

These are the Wrathful One Trailokyavijaya, the Conqueror of the Three Worlds; the vajra goddess the Slayer; and the emanation goddesses, the minor consorts — the one with a bear's head and the one with a mongoose's head.

Oṃ vajrakrodha mahābala hūṃ. Sphoṭa sphoṭa hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajrakrodhī muṇḍe maṃ hūṃ. Oṃ vajrarākṣasamukha hūṃ. Oṃ vajrakaśīkamukhī hūṃ.

These are the Wrathful One Mahābala, the Great Mighty One; the vajra goddess the Vedic One; and the emanation goddesses, the minor consorts — the one with a bear's head and the one with a rat's head.

Oṃ vajrayakṣa sadā hūṃ jaḥ. Oṃ vajrabhairave hūṃ hūṃ. Oṃ vajrāmṛta hūṃ baṃ. Oṃ vajramaraṇi hūṃ hoḥ.

These are the one with a porcupine's head in the east, the one with a crow's head in the south, the one with a vulture's head in the west, and the one with a hawk's head in the north.

For the sake of accomplishing the saṃsāra phurba rite,
and in order to receive empowerment and blessing,
we beseech the wrathful wisdom deities to come.
Having come, O wrathful wisdom deities,

display signs and omens,
and we beseech you to grant the attainments of the phurba.

The time of the great sacred bond has arrived.
The time of the great emanation has arrived.
The time of the great messenger has arrived.
The time of the great sovereign self has arrived.
The time of the great lord of the earth has arrived.
The time of the dog-faced one has arrived.
The time for liberation has arrived.

Having generated the awakening mind,
just as the sons of the buddhas of the three times,
upon us the vidyādhara holders —
the enemies and obstructors who harm and afflict us,
the māras and all those who create obstacles —
through the blessing of the great wrathful ones,
in but an instant, summon them,
liberate them through the rite of fierce activity,
reduce their bodies and speech to powder,
and cause them to experience suffering.

Oṃ laṃ hūṃ laṃ. Stambhanaṃ moḥaṃ ghātaya. Bhagavan. Hrīḥ ṣṭhiḥ
vikṛtavajra hūṃkara hūṃ. Oṃ vajrakīlikīlaya jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ. Sarvaviḡhnān
vajrakīlikīlaya hūṃ phaṭ.

The māras who create obstruction,
and the māra who brings suffering to equality with the mind,
the māra known as Che-ge-mo —
seize them! strike them! bind them utterly!
Drag them away and separate them from their companions!
Draw them from afar and let them speak!
Cast them down and torment them!
Having brought them under my power,
make them obedient and reverential to whatever commands are given.

Hūṃ paravidy ācchindhacchindhahūṃphaṭ. Bindhabindha hūṃ phaṭ.
Gṛhṇagṛhṇa hūṃ phaṭ. Bandha bandha hūṃ phaṭ. Trāśaya trāśaya hūṃ phaṭ.
Hasayara hasayara hrīḥ daṇḍa hūṃ phaṭ. Śīghraṃ ānaya hūṃ phaṭ. Jvālāpaya
jvālāpaya hūṃ phaṭ. Āveśaya āveśaya hūṃ phaṭ. Bindhaya bindhaya hūṃ

phaṭ.

O hosts of messenger servants and those dispatched on missions,
the time of your sacred commitment has come.
Just as the fierce activity is prescribed,
so too grant the blessing of that fierce activity.

Hana hana vajra. Daha daha vajra. Paca paca vajra. Mātha mātha vajra. Jvala
jvala vajra. Suru suru vajra. Muru muru vajra. Kaṭa kaṭaye. Jaye vijaye. Ajite
aparājite. Mārasenāpramardani hūṃ phaṭ.

Whoever, through the command of the vajra secret,
transgresses while laden with misdeeds —
let the great mighty wrathful one
split their head into a hundred pieces!
Listen, O obstructors and misleaders:
do not transgress my command!

Hūṃ mama vaśaṃ kuru.

Those who are vicious and bear a mind of hatred —
begone! whether asuras or gods alike.
The māras who create obstacles for me —
render them without power or magical ability.

Sarva ānaya hūṃ phaṭ. Tathāya tathāya hūṃ phaṭ.

Strike! with the blazing vajra pestle.
Those who transgress the command, laden with misdeeds —
burn their hearts with vajra fire,
and scatter body and mind like dust!

In the blazing fire-pit of the wrathful goddess,
struck and pounded with the vajra hammer,
let them be liberated — even if they be gods.

Khaṭaṃ khaṭaṃ khaṭaṃ. Hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ. Vajra yakṣa krodha
kha kha. Khāhi khāhi. Ha ha. Hūṃ hūṃ. Phaṭ phaṭ.

This is the truth of the nature of reality.
By the blessing of the secret mantra, may it be blessed.
By the blessing of the buddhas, may it come to fruition.
That which is sought is suchness itself.

The kīlaya is to be recited twenty-one times.

Having recited the kīlaya eighteen times, it is at the boundary between the white and black of the heart.

Hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Ho ho ho. Phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ. This is to be recited.

A section of the Root Tantra of the Vajrakīla, brought into accord with the actual Indian manuscript of the master Padmasambhava, by the glorious Sakya Paṇḍita.

Translator's Notes

- The mantra syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan, with minor regularization for readability; some Sanskrit forms reflect Tibetan phonological adaptation and may differ from classical Sanskrit orthography.

The term rendered "liberation through compassion" translates the Tibetan bsgral ba, a technical tantric term meaning the wrathful act of liberating a being by forcibly transferring their consciousness — a ritual killing understood as compassionate. The text explicitly clarifies that the "sacred commitment" (dam tshig, samaya) of this liberation does not consist simply of killing and suppression, but rather of meditating on consciousness as vajra and the aggregates as the vajra body.

The minor consorts called "pha men ma" (phra men ma) are a class of semi-divine female emanation beings frequently appearing in Vajrakīlaya cycles; they are left untranslated as a class-name since no standard English equivalent exists.

"Phavāṅga" (pha wang) in the final group designates a bird not securely identified; it may be a type of myna or magpie. The uncertainty is noted but does not affect the doctrinal content.

- The term rendered "the Vedic One" for rigs byed ma is a tentative reading: rigs byed could refer to the Vedas in the sense of "that which makes known the classes," a possible epithet meaning "she who reveals" or "the Veda-goddess." The precise iconographic identity is unclear from context alone.

The figure called Che-ge-mo in the verse on the māras is a Tibetan proper name for a specific class or named māra; it is left in transliteration as it does not have a standard Sanskrit equivalent in common use.

The term rendered "porcupine" for pu shud is uncertain; this is a Tibetan rendering of an obscure animal name and some traditions identify it differently. It is rendered here following the most commonly cited interpretation.

- The phrase "liberated — even if they be gods" renders the Tibetan term for liberation in the wrathful sense used in tantric contexts: the ritual destruction of obstructors, understood esoterically as freeing their consciousness rather than simply destroying them. This is a standard tantric euphemism (Skt. tarpayati / mokṣayati in this ritual register).

The phrase "boundary between the white and black of the heart" refers to a ritual instruction for kīla placement or insertion at a specific anatomical point on an effigy or ritual support, a detail belonging to the sādhana praxis of Vajrakīla.

The closing colophon identifies this as an excerpt from the root tantra of Vajrakīla, verified against an Indian Sanskrit exemplar by Sakya Paṇḍita (Sa skya Paṇḍita Kun dga' rgyal mtshan,

1182-1251), a significant attestation of this text's transmission history.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.